

Herbs that Dispel Wind-Damp

- Therapeutic Actions: Dispel wind-dampness from the muscles, sinews, joints, and bones. Relieve pain, relax muscles and tendons, open the channels and collaterals, and strengthen tendons and bones.
- Clinical condition: Bi Zheng (painful obstruction syndrome).
- Taste: acrid
- Thermal property: warm or cold and dry
- Channels entered: the Liver and Kidney.

Subcategories of Action

- ☐ Dispel wind and damp to relieve pain.
- ☐ Open peripheral channels and collaterals.
- ☐ Dispel wind and damp by strengthening the tendons and bones.
- ☐ Wind-damp dispelling herbs have excellent anti-inflammatory and analgesic effects.

Wind-Damp Dispelling and Pain-Relieving Herbs

Name	Similarities	Differences
Du Huo (<i>Radix Angelicae Pubescentis</i>)	Dispel wind-dampness, alleviate pain.	Primarily addresses lower-body pain.
Wei Ling Xian (<i>Radix Clematidis</i>)		Treats fish bones obstructing the throat.
Han (Fen) Fang Ji (<i>Radix Stephaniae Tetandreae</i>)		Promotes urination and reduces swelling
Qin Jiao (<i>Radix Gentianae Macrophyllae</i>)		Clears deficiency heat and relieves jaundice

Wind-Damp Dispelling and Channels and Collaterals Opening Herbs

Name	Similarities	Differences
Mu Gua (<i>Fructus Chaenomelis</i>)	Dispel wind-dampness and open channels and collaterals	Relaxes tendons, dissolves dampness, harmonizes Stomach
Sang Zhi (<i>Ramulus Mori</i>)		Relieves pain and stiffness of the upper extremities
Hai Tong Pi (<i>Cortex Erythrinae</i>)		Treats dermatological disorders when used externally

Bai Hua She (<i>Bungarus Parvus</i>)		Strongly opens channels and extinguishes wind to relieve convulsions.
Xi Xian Cao (<i>Herba Siegesbeckiae</i>)		Clears heat, eliminates toxins, relieves carbuncles, swellings, and eczema.

Wind-Damp Dispelling and Tendon and Bone Strengthening Herbs

Name	Similarities	Differences
Sang Ji Sheng (<i>Herba Taxilli</i>)	Dispel wind-damp, strengthen tendons and bones.	Stabilizes fetus
Wu Jia Pi (<i>Cortex Acanthopanax</i>)		Promotes urination and reduces swelling

Dú Huó 独活

“self-reliant existence”

- Radix Angelicae Pubescentis
- English: pubescent angelica root, tu-huo
- Properties: bitter, acrid, warm
- Channels: Kidney, Bladder

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Dispels wind-dampness and alleviates pain

Indications: Use for such disorders as wind-cold-damp painful obstruction, especially in the lower back and legs.

Di Huang, Sang Ji Sheng, Du Zhong (Formula: Du huo ji sheng tang)

Actions: Dispels wind-cold-dampness and releases the exterior

Indications: Used for exterior wind-cold disorders with dampness.

Qiang Huo, Du Huo, Fang Feng

Indications: Treats shao yin headache, toothache, and dermatological disorders

Headache: Xi Xin, Chuan Xiong

Skin disorders: Fang Feng, Di Fu Zi

Main Actions:

- Dispels wind-cold damp, relieves pain, and releases the exterior.

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction.

Du Huo can be used for both acute and chronic wind-cold-damp conditions.

Contraindicated: With Liver wind.

Review Questions:

- Review the actions and indications of Du Huo
- The “Yao Yao” is used to dispel wind-damp and alleviate pain, particularly for treating lower body pain.
- Du Huo, combined with other herbs, is used for whole body pain due to wind-cold-damp.
- Du Huo, combined with an herb for treating exterior wind-cold-damp

Wēi Líng Xiān 威灵仙

“mighty curative immortal” “powerful soul root”

- Radix Clematidis
- English: Chinese clematis root
- Properties: acrid, salty, warm
- Channels: Bladder

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Dispels wind-dampness, unblocks the channels, and alleviates pain.

Indications: Used for wind-damp Bi painful obstruction syndrome. It can be used alone or in a formula.

Note: Wei Ling Xian has an excellent dispersing and penetrating function. It disperses and dispels wind and dampness from the muscles, penetrates and opens peripheral channels and collaterals, and relieves pain.

Actions: Softens and transforms fish bones.

Indications: Used for fish bones lodged in the throat; ineffective in the treatment of deeply lodged or relatively large bones. Treats fish bones blocking the throat.

Swallow the decoction slowly. Vinegar can be added to it.

Main Actions:

Dispels wind-damp, opens channels, and relieves pain.

Treats fish bones blocking the throat.

Dosage: 5-10 grams. Use up to 30 grams of Wei Ling Xian to treat throat obstruction caused by fish bones.

Cautions/contraindications:

The penetrating action of Wei Ling Xian is so intense that it should be used with caution in women who are pregnant or in patients with generalized weakness of qi and/or blood deficiency.

Review Questions:

- The actions and indications

- Wei Ling Xian dispels wind-dampness, unblocks the channels, and alleviates pain.
- The premier herb for treating a fishbone lodged in the throat.
- Compare Du Huo and Wei Ling Xian

Qín Jiāo 秦艽

- Radix Gentianae Macrophyllae
- English: gentiana macrophylla root
- Properties: bitter, acrid, slightly cold
- Channels: Gallbladder, Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Dispels wind-dampness and relaxes the sinews.

Indications: Used for wind-damp painful obstruction and cramping, especially in the extremities.

Actions: Clears deficiency heat.

Indications: Used for yin deficiency patterns that manifest with fever and steaming bone disorder.

Qing Hao, Zhi Mu, Huang Bai

Actions: Resolves dampness and reduces jaundice.

Indications: Used for jaundice due to damp-heat, especially in acute cases and in infants. Yin Chen, Zhi Zi, Huang Qin

Main Actions:

Dispels wind-damp, relaxes the sinews, and clears deficiency heat.

Dosage: 5-10 grams.

Cautions: The use of Qin Jiao may be associated with drowsiness and sedation.

Review Questions:

- Actions and indications
- Qin Jiao dispels wind-damp and relaxes the sinews.
- The herbs clear deficient heat. (review other herbs)
- What are the pharmacological effects needed for treating Bi syndrome?
- How does Qin Jiao affect the central nervous system and relieve pain?

Xī Xiān Cǎo 豨薟草

- Herba Siegesbeckiae
- English: siegesbeckia
- Properties: bitter, cold
- Channels: Kidney, Liver

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Dispels wind-dampness, opens channels and collaterals

Indications: Used for wind-heat-damp painful obstruction. Use alone or in a formula.

Actions: Clears heat, eliminates toxins, and dispels wind-dampness.

Indications: Used for treating damp-heat sores and itching, as well as wind-damp rash. Used internally and externally.

Actions: Lowers blood pressure**Main Actions:**

- Dispels wind-dampness, opens channels and collaterals.
- Clears heat, eliminates toxins.

Dosage: 10 – 15 grams in decoction. Fresh Xi Xian Cao is more effective in clearing heat and eliminating toxins.

Review Questions:

- Actions and indications of Xi Xian Cao
- Herbs that dispel wind-dampness and open channels and collaterals

Mù Guā 木瓜

“wood fruit” or “wood melon”

- Fructus Chaenomeles
- English: Chinese quince fruit, chaenomeles
- Properties: sour, slightly warm
- Channels: Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Relaxes the sinews, opens channels and collaterals.

Indications: Used for damp painful obstruction in the extremities, especially with severe cramping pain and weakness in the lower back and lower extremities.

Indications: Muscle stiffness and spasms with difficulty moving
Ru Xiang, Mo Yao, Sheng Di Huang

Indications: Muscle spasms due to blood deficiency
Dang Gui, Bai Shao

Indications: Weakness and atrophy of muscles in the lower extremities
Du Huo, Shang Ji Sheng

Actions: Harmonizes the Stomach and transforms dampness.

Indications: Used for vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal pain, spasms, and cramping of the calves.

Actions: Reduces food stagnation.

Indications: Used for indigestion

Main Actions:

- Relaxes the sinews, opens channels, and collaterals
- Harmonizes the Stomach and transforms dampness
- Reduces food stagnation

Dosage: 6 – 12 grams in decoction.

Review Questions:

- The actions and indications of Mu Gua
- “Yao Yao” for Bi syndrome with muscle spasm, pain, and weakness.
- Herb that harmonizes the Stomach and transforms dampness
- Mu Gua is used as a digestive aid

Sāng Zhī 桑枝

“mulberry twigs”

- Ramulus Mori Albae
- English: mulberry twig, morus twig
- Properties: bitter, neutral
- Channels: Liver

Actions and Indications:**Actions: Dispels wind, unblocks the channels, and benefits joints**

Indications: Used for wind-damp painful obstruction, especially in the upper extremities

Indications: Used for edema

Main Actions:

- Dispels wind, unblocks the channels, and benefits joints.

Dosage: 10 – 30 grams in decoction.

Review Questions:

- The herb that dispels wind, unblocks the channels, and benefits joints for Upper body Bi syndrome.

Hǎi Tóng Pí 海桐皮

- Cortex Erythrinae
- English: coral-bean bark, erythrina bark
- Properties: bitter, acrid, neutral
- Channels: Liver, Spleen, Kidney

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Dispels wind-dampness and opens channels and collaterals

Indications: Used for wind-damp painful obstruction, especially when there is soreness and pain in the lower back and knees or spasms of the extremities

Actions: Kills parasites and relieves itching

Indications: Used topically (wash or ointment) for scabies and other skin lesions

Main Actions:

Dispels wind-dampness and opens channels and collaterals

Dosage: 6-12 grams

Hàn (Fě) Fáng Jǐ 防己 **Guǎng (Mù) Fáng Jǐ 广防己**

- Radix Stephaniae Tetrandrae (Han Fang Ji)
- Radix Aristolochiae Fangchi (Guang Fang Ji)
- English: four-stamen Stephania root, aristolochia root
- Properties: bitter, acrid, cold
- Channels: Bladder, Spleen, Kidney

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Expels wind-damp and alleviates pain

Indications: Used for wind-damp-heat collecting in the channels with such symptoms as fever and red, swollen, hot, and painful joints.

Actions: Promotes urination, clears lower jiao damp-heat, and reduces edema

Indications: Used for edema (especially in the lower body), damp leg qi, or ascites due to damp accumulating in the lower burner

- Cold-damp Bi: Rou Gui, Fu Zi
- Edema, water retention in the abdomen (shi):
Huang Qi, Gui Zhi, Fu Ling, Gan Cao (Formula: Fang Ji Fu Ling Tang)
- Edema, sweating, aversion to wind, heavy sensation, floating pulse (Xu):
Huang Qi, Bai Zhu, Gan Cao, Sheng Jiang, Da Zao (Fang Ji Huang Qi Tang)

Main Actions:

- Dispels wind-damp to relieve pain and promotes urination.

Notes: Han Fang Ji is stronger in promoting urination and reducing edema, Mu Fang Ji is stronger in expelling wind-damp and alleviating pain.

Dosage: 5-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions:

Guang (Mu) Fang Ji is Toxic, Han Fang Ji is bitter and cold; it damages the middle jiao, and should be used with caution in patients with yin deficiency, no signs of damp-heat, or in patients with deficiency and cold of the Spleen and Stomach.

Toxicology:

Guang Fang Ji is toxic, and its use should be avoided. The toxic component is aristolochic acid. It has been shown to affect the liver, kidneys, and adrenal glands.

Herb-drug interaction: Fen Fang Ji has a diuretic effect; concurrent use with diuretic drugs may lead to increased elimination of water and or electrolytes. Examples of diuretics include Lasix, Bumex, and Demadex.)

Review Questions:

- The temperature of Fang Ji
- Common actions & indications of Fang Ji.
- The differences of (Han (Fen) Fang Ji & Guang (Mu) Fang Ji)
- Which Fang Ji is Toxic?
- Fang Ji for wind-damp-heat Bi Syndrome and jiao damp-heat, and reduces edema.

Bái Huā Shé 白花蛇

“white flower snake” “white-patterned snake”

- Bungarus multicinctus Blyth
- English: Bungarus
- Properties: sweet, salty, warm, toxic
- Channels: Liver

Actions and Indications:

Actions: Powerfully extinguishes wind, opens channels, and collaterals

Indications: Used for chronic wind-dampness with numbness, paralysis, and cramping of the sinews; also for itching skin and rashes.

Bai Hua She has an excellent dispersing function that travels along the skin, enters the internal organs, and penetrates to the bone, venting wind from the bones, sinews, and skin. It is an essential medicine that powerfully extinguishes and expels wind toxins.

Actions: Dispels wind from the skin

Indications: Used for tinea, numbness of the skin, or any kind of rash.

Actions: Stops convulsions

Indications: Used for any kind of spasms, tremors, wind-stroke, tetanus, or seizures.

Main Actions:

- Extinguishes wind, opens channels, and collaterals.
- Dispels wind from the skin
- Stops convulsions

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction. 1.0 to 1.5 grams in powder form. Bai Hua She is also used as a medicinal wine.

Review Questions:

- The actions and indications of Bai Hua She She Cao.
- The herb that powerfully extinguishes wind, opens channels and collaterals for chronic Bi syndrome.
- Herb that dispels wind for skin conditions
- Herb stops convulsions
- What are the major pharmacological effects of Bai Hua She?
- What are the cautions of Herb-Drug interaction when prescribing Bai Hua She?

Sang Ji Sheng 桑寄生

- Herba Taxilli
- English: taxillus, Chinese tacillus
- Properties: bitter, sweet, neutral
- Channels:

Actions and Indications:**Actions: Tonifies the Liver and Kidney, strengthens the sinews and bones, dispels wind-dampness**

Indications: Liver and kidney deficiency with soreness and pain in the lower back and legs, joint problems, numbness and weakness, and atrophy of the sinews and bones.

- Du Huo Ji Shang Tang

Actions: Tonifies the Liver and Kidney, nourishes the blood, and calms the fetus.

Indications: restless fetus or uterine bleeding during pregnancy with Liver and Kidney Xu (Chong and Ren).

Actions: Sang Ji Shang is neither hot nor cold in nature; it tonifies the Liver and Kidney yin and blood, expels wind-dampness, and calms the fetus during pregnancy.

Indications: It is one of the common herbs being used for treating wind-cold damp Bi syndrome with Liver and Kidney deficiency, or supporting a pregnancy.

- Wind-cold damp Bi (lower back and leg pain) with Liver and Kidney deficiency
 - Du Hou, Niu Xi, Du Zhong, Wu Jia Pi
- Restless fetus with Liver and Kidney deficiency
 - Ai Ye, E Jiao, Xu Duan, Du Zhong

Main Actions:

- Expels wind-cold
- Tonifies the Liver and Kidney
- Calms fetus

Dosage: 10-20 grams in decoction.

Review Questions:

- What channels does Sang Ji Seng enter?
- Herbs for treating wind-damp Bi
- Herb that tonifies the Liver and Kidney
- Herbs that calm the fetus

Wǔ Jiā Pí 五加皮

“five plus bark” “bark of five additions”

- Cortex Acanthopanax Gracilistylis Radicis
- English: Acanthopanax root bark
- Properties: acrid, bitter, warm
- Channels: Kidney, Liver

Actions: Dispels wind-dampness and strengthens the tendons and bones

Indications: Used for chronic wind-cold-damp painful obstruction where chronic Liver and Kidney deficiency causes weak or soft sinews and bones. It includes delayed motor development in children.

- Wind-cold damp Bi syndrome:
 - Du Huo, Fang Feng, Wei Ling Xian
- Delayed motor development in children.
 - Mu Gua, Huai Niu Xi, Shang Ji Sheng

Actions: Dispels water retention and reduces swelling

Indications: Used for urinary difficulty and edema.

- Da Fu Pi, Fu Ling Pi, Jiang Pi

Main Actions:

- Dispels wind-dampness and strengthens bones and tendons.

Dosage: 5-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions: Use of Wu Jia Pi may be associated with drowsiness and sedation.

Review Questions:

- Herbs that dispel wind-dampness and strengthen the tendons and bones
- Herbs that dispel water retention and reduce swelling
- What is the pharmacological effect of Wu Jia Pi to treat Bi?